

## **Notrump Bidding**

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced\* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced\* distribution

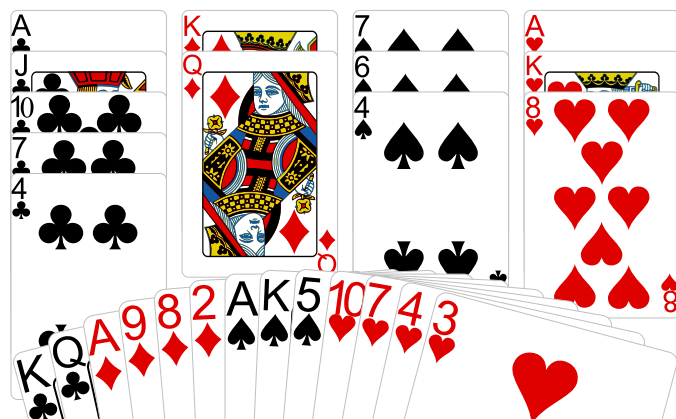
- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

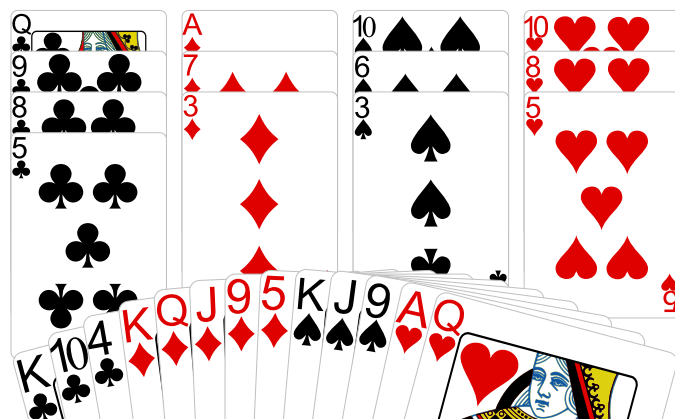
\*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Deal 1 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least \_\_\_\_ winners



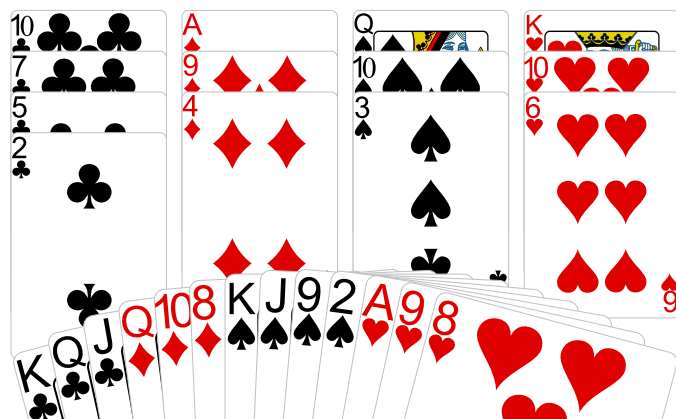
| Count Sure Winners            |        |         |          |       |
|-------------------------------|--------|---------|----------|-------|
| ♠                             | ♥      | ♦       | ♣        | Total |
|                               |        |         |          |       |
| Decide How to Develop Winners |        |         |          |       |
| Promotion                     | Length | Finesse | End Play |       |
|                               |        |         |          |       |

Deal 2 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least \_\_\_\_ winners



| Count Sure Winners            |        |         |          |       |
|-------------------------------|--------|---------|----------|-------|
| ♠                             | ♥      | ♦       | ♣        | Total |
|                               |        |         |          |       |
| Decide How to Develop Winners |        |         |          |       |
| Promotion                     | Length | Finesse | End Play |       |
|                               |        |         |          |       |

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least \_\_\_\_ winners



| Count Sure Winners            |        |         |          |       |
|-------------------------------|--------|---------|----------|-------|
| ♠                             | ♥      | ♦       | ♣        | Total |
|                               |        |         |          |       |
| Decide How to Develop Winners |        |         |          |       |
| Promotion                     | Length | Finesse | End Play |       |
|                               |        |         |          |       |

Deal 4 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least \_\_\_\_ winners



| Count Sure Winners            |        |         |          |       |
|-------------------------------|--------|---------|----------|-------|
| ♠                             | ♥      | ♦       | ♣        | Total |
|                               |        |         |          |       |
| Decide How to Develop Winners |        |         |          |       |
| Promotion                     | Length | Finesse | End Play |       |
|                               |        |         |          |       |

Board: 1  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 6NT  
Declarer: North

Board: 2  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 3NT  
Declarer: East

Board: 3  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 3NT  
Declarer: South

Board: 4  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 6NT  
Declarer: West

Board: 5  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 6NT  
Declarer: North

**Deal 1**

North Deals  
None Vul

♠ Q J 8  
♥ 6 2  
♦ T 5 4 3  
♣ 9 8 5 2

16  
3      4  
17

West

All Pass

6NT by North

to 6NT.

♠ A K 5

♥ T 7 4 3

♦ A 9 8 2

♣ K Q



♠ 7 6 4

♥ A K 8

♦ K Q

♣ A J T 7 4

North

1NT

East

Pass

South

6NT

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 16

This is another example of "She who knows, goes."

SOUTH has a solid 18 points, (1 extra for the fifth Club), so when NORTH opens 1NT

she

KNOWS

that together they must hold at least 33 points.  
The may even have 35 points.

In any case they should be in slam, so SOUTH

GOES

**Deal 2**

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ T 6 3  
♥ T 8 5  
♦ A 7 3  
♣ Q 9 8 5

9  
6    19  
6

♠ A 8 5 2

♥ 6 3 2

♦ T 8 4 2

♣ A J



♠ Q 7 4

♥ K J 9 7 4

♦ 6

♣ 7 6 3 2

♠ K J 9

♥ A Q

♦ K Q J 9 5

♣ K T 4

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 17

EAST has 20 points, counting one extra for the fifth Diamond. Just right to open 2NT.

WEST has 6 points, just enough to bid 3NT.

(20 + 6 = 26) (21 + 6 = 27)

West

North

East

South

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

**Deal 3**

North Deals  
E-W Vul

♠ A 8 5  
♥ Q J 7 2  
♦ J 7 3  
♣ 8 4 3

9  
8 7  
16

♠ Q T 3  
♥ K T 6  
♦ A 9 4  
♣ T 7 5 2



♠ K J 9 2  
♥ A 9 8  
♦ Q T 8  
♣ K Q J

♠ 7 6 4  
♥ 5 4 3  
♦ K 6 5 2  
♣ A 9 6

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | Pass  |      | 1NT   |
| Pass         | 2NT   | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |

**Baker Bidpractice/Set1 18**

After NORTH passes initially, SOUTH opens 1NT.

With 9 points, NORTH has invitational strength, so he says 2NT.

SOUTH has a small problem - NORTH's bid tells her to bid 3NT with 17 points, but to pass

with 15 points. Her problem is that she has 16! Since it looks to her like a "good" 16 points

she bids 3NT. If those 10's and 9's had been 4's and 3's she would have passed.

**Deal 4**

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 9 3  
 ♥ K Q T  
 ♦ A J 7  
 ♣ Q T 8

5  
 17 15  
 3

♠ J 8 5  
 ♥ 7 6 5 2  
 ♦ 9 8 4 2  
 ♣ A 5



♠ T 6 4 2  
 ♥ J 9 3  
 ♦ Q 5 3  
 ♣ 9 6 3

♠ A 7  
 ♥ A 8 4  
 ♦ K T 6  
 ♣ K J 7 4 2

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| 1NT         | Pass  | 4NT  | Pass  |
| 6NT         |       |      | Pass  |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6NT by West |       |      |       |

**Baker Bidpractice/Set1 19**

WEST has a great 1NT hand - 17 points and 4-3-3-3 shape.

EAST has 16 points; he figures it is possible that WEST can make a slam, but only

if she has a 17 point opener. So he bids 4NT, expecting WEST to bid 6NT if she has 17 points

but to pass if she has fewer.

He figured right - WEST had 17 points so she bid 6NT.

**Deal 5**

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J T 9 6 5 3 2  
♥ J 4 3  
♦ 3  
♣ A 4

15  
6 3  
16

♠ A 7 4  
♥ Q 9 6  
♦ K Q 5 2  
♣ K J 8



♠ K 8  
♥ A K 5  
♦ A 8  
♣ Q T 9 6 3 2

♠ Q  
♥ T 8 7 2  
♦ J T 9 7 6 4  
♣ 7 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 20

SOUTH definitely does NOT have a balanced hand. She has two doubletons and a

6-card Club suit.

But she DOES have 18 points, (two extra for the fifth and sixth Clubs), and her 18 added to

NORTH's minimum of 15 is enough to bid 6NT.

Notice how easy this will be to play once that Club suit is established.